ACTION TRIGGERS · DEFENCE, SECURITY & RESILIENCE · 5 NOVEMBER 2026

Rearmament Will Leave Companies Paying for Sabotage, Call-Ups and Shelters in 2027

Governments are claiming workers, plants, ships and basements for defence while leaving the cost with their owners, and a court has let insurers treat unattributed sabotage as war. The January renewals and Germany's first compulsory call-ups in 2027 will show who pays.

Produced using Shaping Tomorrow's six-stage process for converting external change into decision-ready intelligence.
Scanned and filtered by AI. Stress-tested and judged by humans.

How long you have to get ready

The six actions below, from today to the moment each falls due. Select a pill to see what would change it, or a number to go to the action.

Since the last Action Triggers on 28 August 2026: NEW 2 REVISED 4

Now

	Now to Dec 2026 IMMEDIATE	Jan to Mar 2027 NEXT QUARTER	Apr to Jun 2027 NEXT PLANNING CYCLE
1 REVISED **Ask brokers in writing how the war exclusion would treat a sabotage loss with a suspected state link, and size the loss you would keep.** Chief financial officer, with the risk manager and broker	DECIDE	◇ 1 Jan: insurance renewals	
5 REVISED **Keep the bill-of-materials screen for China's 0.1% rule live, and plan against 10 January 2027 unless the 10 November date is confirmed.** Head of trade compliance, with procurement	PREPARE ◇ 10 Nov: original expiry date	◇ 10 Jan: extended date, if confirmed	
2 REVISED **Put the state's claims on your staff, sites and buildings into 2027 budgets and bids: reservist absences, plant security and shelter requests.** Chief operating officer, with HR, property and security		PREPARE 31 Mar: claims costed in 2027 budgets ◇	May: EU critical-entity duties start ◇
3 NEW **List the American forces, software and cloud services each plan depends on, cost a shared European replacement for the top three, and write an exit plan for each critical cloud service.** Defence ministries and joint staffs, with information chiefs	◇ 6 Nov: US posture options due	DECIDE 31 Mar: shared replacements costed ◇	
4 REVISED **Give one owner the dated permissions and deadlines that now decide delivery: EU transfer**		◇ 1 Jan: US sourcing waivers stop	PREPARE

certificates, US sourcing plans and the end-2028 contract cut-off.

Programme director, with export compliance and finance

6 NEW **Keep watch on the date the UK sets for reaching 3% of GDP, and tie UK capacity and credit to funded programmes until then.**

Chief financial officers of UK defence suppliers, with their lenders

MONITOR

30 Apr: spending review watch date

time to get ready ◇ key date DECIDE act now PREPARE get ready to act MONITOR watch it

Early warnings

Signals the portfolio surfaced before consensus formed, in the order they hardened.

LEAD TIME 9 WEEKS AHEAD · SIGNAL SCAN · SIGNAL SCAN · CHANGE TRACKER

Sabotage losses with a suspected but unproven state link may stay with the operator when policies renew in 2027.

INITIAL SIGNAL

We identified in early September that deniable sabotage of European infrastructure falls between the war clause and the terrorism pool, so it is uninsured by default while the market redrafts its war wordings.

NOW EVIDENT

- **The ruling**: a court held that the Russia-Ukraine war only needed to be a significant cause of the Nord Stream loss, and found that met despite uncertainty about the perpetrator and outside an active war zone.
- **The attacks**: German authorities recorded 165 suspected sabotage cases since the start of 2026, and 747 drone incidents from January to the end of August.
- **The capacity**: global political violence and terrorism premium of around US$1.5 billion against insured loss estimates approaching double that, with many reinsurers declining critical infrastructure.
- **The response**: Berlin's two new ordinances of 28 October tighten controls and staff vetting at critical sites, and say nothing about who bears a loss.

INSURANCE RENEWALS **January 2027**

US TERRORISM BACKSTOP (TRIPRA) EXPIRES **end of 2027**

DECIDE

Finance chiefs of grid, pipeline, telecoms and defence-supply operators should settle in writing how their cover treats an unattributed attack.

LEAD TIME 7 WEEKS AHEAD | SIGNAL SCAN | CHANGE TRACKER

Arms plants will be held to security standards raised after each attack, with little public money to meet them.

INITIAL SIGNAL

We read three governments telling the owners of drone and munitions plants to raise their own security after arson and explosions, with no designation, contract standard or funding line behind the request.

NOW EVIDENT

- **Poland**: an incendiary attack at WB Electronics caused damage of at least 15 million złoty, and the deputy interior minister promised recommendations and more police.
- **Bulgaria**: after explosions at an Emco depot the interior minister said the state will step in, while the firm said the site had passed seven ministry inspections this year.
- **The money**: the EU pays up to €500,000 per project for site protection, and duties for critical entities start in May 2027.

EU CRITICAL-ENTITY DUTIES START **May 2027**

PREPARE

Primes and tier-2 suppliers should cost the standard a ministry would impose after a fire at their own site and put it into current bids.

LEAD TIME 6 WEEKS AHEAD | SIGNAL SCAN

Employers will pay for most of the time their staff spend on German reserve call-ups from 2027.

INITIAL SIGNAL

We identified that Germany's Reserve Strengthening Act ends the employer's consent to call-ups while its impact statement finds that business compliance costs fall slightly.

NOW EVIDENT

- **The veto**: firms can no longer simply veto a call-up, and the Bundeswehr decides on deferral requests; call-up notice doubles to eight weeks.
- **The gap**: replacement costs are repaid at about €76 to €190 a day for at most 30 days and one exercise a year, against annual caps of three to twelve weeks.
- **The scale**: the 7,500 reserve posts funded for 2026 equal about 2.73 million service days, before a reserve that must reach at least 200,000 by 2033.

EMPLOYER CONSENT ENDS **early 2027** RESERVE TARGET **200,000 by 2033**

PREPARE

HR and finance chiefs, above all in the Mittelstand, should map reserve liability and price a replacement day now.

LEAD TIME 5 WEEKS AHEAD SIGNAL SCAN

NATO's reinforcement plans may find too few commercial ships and crews available when they are called on.

INITIAL SIGNAL

We read NATO's plans resting on the assumption that commercial shipping will be available when required, an assumption the Council on Geostrategy calls obsolete, while Washington pays to guarantee its own.

NOW EVIDENT

- **The US**: guaranteed access to 60 commercially operated ships and more than 2,400 trained mariners, at a $6.5 million retainer per vessel and $390 million in 2026.
- **NATO**: its Assured Access Contract gave access to up to 15 Ro/Ro ships, and the Ankara declaration's only sea sentence concerns Hormuz.
- **Crews**: a 15% shortfall in mariners for US emergency sealift, and only 38% of EU shipping-sector seafarers are EU citizens.

US RETAINER **$6.5 million per ship** NATO POOLED CONTRACT **up to 15 ships**

PREPARE

Shipowners, war-risk underwriters and movement planners should price a retainer and agree military-cargo war-risk terms before a crisis.

LEAD TIME 1 WEEK AHEAD | SIGNAL SCAN | DECISION INTELLIGENCE

Defence orders will bunch up before the end of 2028, and suppliers' order books will lengthen faster than their output.

INITIAL SIGNAL

We identified that the EU's fiscal waiver for defence covers deliveries after 2028 only when they were contracted before the end of 2028, so ministries have reason to sign early whatever factories can build.

NOW EVIDENT

- **The rule**: the Commission's recommendation for Greece covers deliveries after 2028 only if contracted before end-2028, inside a cap of 1.5% of GDP.
- **The orders**: Germany plans more than €60 billion of military procurement in 2027, against €45 billion this year.
- **The backlogs**: Rheinmetall's backlog reached €80.5 billion, Saab's a record SEK 364.2 billion, and sector backlogs stand at more than five times revenue.

CONTRACT CUT-OFF FOR FISCAL COVER **end of 2028**

PREPARE

Procurement agencies and prime finance chiefs should map each programme by signature date and book supplier capacity before the queue forms.

Assumptions that have shifted

Cycle-over-cycle assumption changes, in decreasing order of strategic weight.

SHIFT 1 OF 5 SPLIT

Permits and approvals, more than factory capacity, limit how fast Europe rearms

PRIOR CYCLE HELD

The August synthesis concluded that "the load-bearing variable for the next two years is permission rather than capacity", after the gates moved into recruitment, engagement authority, permitting and repair data.

THIS CYCLE READS

Both now bind. The permission gates have acquired dates and paperwork, and order books show that capacity still limits output.

- **Certificates**: the faster EU transfer licence needs both parties certified, the law sets no deadline for deciding an application, and fifty-five firms were certified at the last count, in 2016.
- **US sourcing**: from 1 January 2027 contractors lose non-availability waivers unless they file a funded plan to qualify a second source.
- **Capacity**: the August call that order books would keep growing faster than output is on track: Rheinmetall's backlog of €80.5 billion sits against first-half sales of €5,227 million.

FORWARD THESIS

Plan each delivery against both a dated permission and a capacity slot. The tripwire is **a member state's certifying authority publishing criteria and a decision period before 30 June 2027**, which would turn the certificate into a timetable.

SHIFT 2 OF 5 WEAKENED

The money is settled, so delivery is the only question left

PRIOR CYCLE HELD

The August synthesis held that "money is no longer the question": budgets had cleared, and the open question was whether industry could absorb them.

THIS CYCLE READS

Money is settled in Germany and in the EU's loan instrument, which has begun paying out. It is not settled in the United Kingdom or in most smaller allies.

- **United Kingdom**: funded spending at 2.6% of GDP in 2026–27 and 2.7% in 2027–28 and 2028–29, about £4.7 billion still to be identified before the 28 October Budget, and the date for 3% waiting on a 2027 spending review.
- **Allies**: of 16 baseline NATO allies, few have published a roadmap for financing their budgets.
- **Germany**: more than €60 billion of military procurement planned for 2027, against €45 billion this year.

FORWARD THESIS

Treat the UK and the smaller allies as funded to a plateau, not a ramp. The tripwire is **the Treasury confirming a defence spending review later than 30 April 2027**.

SHIFT 3 OF 5 HOLDING

Attacks on Europe's infrastructure will keep coming

PRIOR CYCLE HELD

The August synthesis graded "critical infrastructure under live attack" as the condition to plan under, with drones over NATO's eastern members and jamming at sea.

THIS CYCLE READS

The attacks continued and reached defence suppliers' own sites. The August call that shooting down drones would stay routine through the autumn is on track.

- **Airspace**: Romania has logged 54 drone intrusions since Russia's full-scale invasion, 35 of them this year, and shot down six in 2026; NATO jets shot down a drone over Lithuania.
- **Sabotage**: German authorities recorded 165 suspected sabotage cases in 2026 and two grid substations were targeted within 24 hours in early September.
- **Plants**: arson at a Polish drone maker, explosions at a Bulgarian depot, a fire at an Estonian supplier under investigation and a foiled arson attempt in Slovakia, all within weeks.

FORWARD THESIS

Plan for continued attack, and for the cost of protection and loss to fall on owners. The tripwire is **a member state notifying a defence manufacturer as a critical entity**, which would bring public standards, and possibly public money, to plant security.

SHIFT 4 OF 5 WEAKENED

Investors in defence technology are locked in with no way out

PRIOR CYCLE HELD

The August synthesis held that "capital was trapped without exits", and the August briefing found the defence-tech boom funding very few winners.

THIS CYCLE READS

Private capital restarted after two cycles without movement. Helsing raised $1.8 billion and Quantum Systems €1 billion, and the October tracker moved defence-tech capital back to Stable. The money is still going to a few leaders.

FORWARD THESIS

Treat late-stage money as open for a handful of leaders and still closed for most. The tripwire is **a second round of comparable size going to a firm outside the current leaders**.

SHIFT 5 OF 5 WEAKENED

China's suspended export controls come back on 10 November

PRIOR CYCLE HELD

The August briefing called it: "China's suspended export controls will return on 10 November 2026, catching civil products in which Chinese-origin controlled inputs reach 0.1% of value."

THIS CYCLE READS

China's commerce ministry said on 28 September that the arrangement behind the suspension runs to 10 January 2027, but no notice had formally moved the 10 November date by 22 October. The rule is unchanged; its date is likely to move.

FORWARD THESIS

Keep the screen and plan against the later date. The tripwire is **a formal notice moving the expiry to 10 January 2027, or the controls taking effect on 10 November**.

Actions triggered

Each trigger names why it activates now, why it matters, the recommended actions, the primary decision owner, the decision window, and the conditions under which the recommendation should be reviewed.

DECIDE ACTION 1 SIGNAL SCAN SIGNAL SCAN CHANGE TRACKER

Ask brokers in writing how the war exclusion would treat a sabotage loss with a suspected state link, and size the loss you would keep.

TRIGGER CONDITION

This recommendation has been activated because a court applied a war exclusion to the Nord Stream loss despite uncertainty about the perpetrator, because German authorities recorded 165 suspected sabotage cases this year, because political violence premium runs at around half its loss estimates, and because most insurance programmes still treat sabotage as an insured peril.

PRIMARY DECISION OWNER **Chief financial officer, with the risk manager and broker**

DECISION WINDOW IMMEDIATE **Before the January 2027 renewals**

WHY THIS NOW MATTERS

A minister's verdict does not settle attribution, so the policy wording decides who pays, and the renewal is the last point to change it before a loss.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- **Immediate:** obtain a written broker position covering property, business interruption, cyber and political violence.
- **Immediate:** size a retained-loss case for a multi-day outage at the most exposed site.
- **Next quarter:** price standalone sabotage or political violence cover where the property policy may not respond.
- **Follow-on:** carry the gap into lender covenants and continuity plans.

REVIEW CONDITIONS

ESCALATE If an insurer cites the Nord Stream judgment to decline or cut a European infrastructure sabotage claim, fund the retained loss in the 2027 budget and buy standalone cover.

SCALE BACK If a market body or major insurer publishes a clause on state-linked sabotage before 30 June 2027, renegotiate to that clause and drop the standalone search.

STAND DOWN If courts read war exclusions narrowly enough that grey-zone losses are paid under all-risk property policies, return to ordinary renewal.

PREPARE ACTION 2 SIGNAL SCAN SIGNAL SCAN SIGNAL SCAN

Put the state's claims on your staff, sites and buildings into 2027 budgets and bids: reservist absences, plant security and shelter requests.

TRIGGER CONDITION

This recommendation has been activated because Germany's reserve bill ends the employer's veto while repaying at most 30 days of call-ups that can run to twelve weeks, because three governments told arms plant owners to raise their own security, because Germany is recording basements and car parks as shelters with no split of upkeep costs, and because the reserve bill books no cost to business.

PRIMARY DECISION OWNER **Chief operating officer, with HR, property and security**

DECISION WINDOW NEXT QUARTER **In 2027 budgets and bids, by 31 March 2027**

WHY THIS NOW MATTERS

Each claim arrives as a duty without a price, so the firm that sizes it first can write it into bids and leases while the terms are still open.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- **Immediate:** map staff with reserve liability, where they disclose it, and price a replacement day against the €76 to €190 band.
- **Next quarter:** cost the security standard a ministry would impose after an attack on your site, and put it into current bids.
- **Next quarter:** set a policy for shelter designation requests: who may agree, and what lease and cover wording it triggers.
- **Follow-on:** seek designation as a critical entity where it brings public standards and funding.

REVIEW CONDITIONS

RAISE TO DECIDE If the Bundestag passes the reserve bill with the 30-day reimbursement cap intact, fund replacement cover for every reservist role in the 2027 budget.

SCALE BACK If the Bundesrat secures day-one reimbursement without the 30-day cap, keep the staff map and drop the replacement budget.

RAISE TO DECIDE If a German federal or Land document names who pays for upkeep at designated private car parks or basements, re-price lease, cover and capital plans for underground assets.

DECIDE ACTION 3 DECISION INTELLIGENCE CHANGE TRACKER CHANGE TRACKER

List the American forces, software and cloud services each plan depends on, cost a shared European replacement for the top three, and write an exit plan for each critical cloud service.

TRIGGER CONDITION

This recommendation has been activated because the Pentagon is weighing withdrawing 25,000 to 40,000 troops from Europe with posture options due by 6 November, because users of the US Maven AI system doubled to over 100,000 this year and NATO runs it at its headquarters, because three non-EU providers control over 70% of Europe's cloud market, and because the Netherlands now requires exit plans for important cloud services.

PRIMARY DECISION OWNER Defence ministries and joint staffs, with information chiefs

DECISION WINDOW NEXT QUARTER Costed replacements by 31 March 2027; exit plans by 30 June 2027

WHY THIS NOW MATTERS

The Kiel Institute puts the cost of replacing critical US capabilities at €150 billion to €200 billion, more than most states can carry alone, so the first gaps filled together set the pattern for the rest.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- **Immediate:** list the US enablers, software and cloud services each operational plan depends on.
- **Next quarter:** cost a shared replacement for the top three with neighbouring states.
- **Next quarter:** write an exit plan for each critical function on non-European cloud and AI.
- **Follow-on:** test the most critical exit plan in an exercise.

REVIEW CONDITIONS

ESCALATE If the US cuts the forces it earmarks for NATO crises by half, bring the shared-replacement decision into this quarter.

SCALE BACK If Congress holds a floor of 76,000 US troops in Europe in the final defence bill, keep the list and stage the replacements over a longer period.

SCALE BACK If NATO or the EU funds a shared programme for the same enablers, join it rather than cost a separate one.

PREPARE ACTION 4 SIGNAL SCAN SIGNAL SCAN SIGNAL SCAN

Give one owner the dated permissions and deadlines that now decide delivery: EU transfer certificates, US sourcing plans and the end-2028 contract cut-off.

TRIGGER CONDITION

This recommendation has been activated because the faster EU transfer licence needs both parties certified and the law sets no deadline for deciding an application, because US waivers for covered materials stop on 1 January 2027 unless a funded second-source plan is accepted, because EU fiscal cover after 2028 follows the contract date, and because sector order books already stand at more than five times revenue.

PRIMARY DECISION OWNER Programme director, with export compliance and finance

DECISION WINDOW NEXT PLANNING CYCLE In 2027 programme plans

WHY THIS NOW MATTERS

A general licence moves goods in one to three days against six to seven weeks for an individual licence, and a signature after 2028 loses fiscal cover, so a missed paper deadline now costs months of delivery later.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- **Immediate:** map every cross-border supply link by certification status and decide which suppliers to sponsor.
- **Next quarter:** start certification files, including the compliance programme the senior executive must countersign.
- **Next quarter:** map each large programme by signature date, delivery slot and payer, and book supplier capacity before the cut-off crowds it.
- **Follow-on:** fund second-source qualification for covered materials where US contracts depend on it.

REVIEW CONDITIONS

RAISE TO DECIDE If a member state's certifying authority publishes criteria and a decision period before 30 June 2027, file for certification against that timetable.

RAISE TO DECIDE If a finance ministry or fiscal institution names 31 December 2028 as a contract-signature deadline before 30 June 2027, move capacity booking and financing for post-2028 deliveries into 2027.

SCALE BACK If the implementing regulations for the US order leave your covered materials out of scope, drop the second-source programme and keep the bill of materials.

PREPARE ACTION 5 DECISION INTELLIGENCE

Keep the bill-of-materials screen for China's 0.1% rule live, and plan against 10 January 2027 unless the 10 November date is confirmed.

TRIGGER CONDITION

This recommendation has been activated because China's commerce ministry said on 28 September that the arrangement behind the suspension runs to 10 January 2027, because no notice had formally moved the 10 November date by 22 October, and because the rule catches civil products in which Chinese-origin controlled inputs reach 0.1% of value.

PRIMARY DECISION OWNER Head of trade compliance, with procurement

DECISION WINDOW IMMEDIATE Before 10 November 2026, and again before 10 January 2027

WHY THIS NOW MATTERS

An extension moves the date, not the rule, and a screen allowed to lapse now would need rebuilding within two months.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- **Immediate:** confirm which products cross the 0.1% threshold and where alternative inputs exist.
- **Immediate:** prepare licence applications for the products that cannot be re-sourced.
- **Follow-on:** watch for China requiring licences for finished goods sent to G7 markets, the signpost the August briefing set for December 2027.

REVIEW CONDITIONS

ESCALATE If the controls take effect on 10 November, file licence applications at once and switch to alternative inputs.

SCALE BACK If a formal notice moves the expiry to 10 January 2027, keep the screen and re-date the licence plan.

STAND DOWN If a formal notice extends the suspension beyond the end of 2027, keep the screen as a watch item only.

MONITOR ACTION 6 SIGNAL SCAN

Keep watch on the date the UK sets for reaching 3% of GDP, and tie UK capacity and credit to funded programmes until then.

TRIGGER CONDITION

This recommendation has been activated because UK funded spending goes flat at 2.7% of GDP from 2027–28, because about £4.7 billion of the plan was still to be found before the 28 October Budget, because the date for 3% waits on a 2027 spending review that reports say may slip to the autumn, and because the plan's delay has already pushed some small businesses out of the defence sector.

PRIMARY DECISION OWNER	**Chief financial officers of UK defence suppliers, with their lenders**
DECISION WINDOW MONITOR ONLY	**Reassess at the 2027 spending review**

WHY THIS NOW MATTERS

Capacity, hiring and credit built on the 3.5% headline assume a ramp, while the funded numbers describe a plateau.

RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

- **Immediate:** split UK plans into funded programmes and a separate 3% case.
- **Follow-on:** agree bridging terms with lenders that extend if the review slips.

REVIEW CONDITIONS

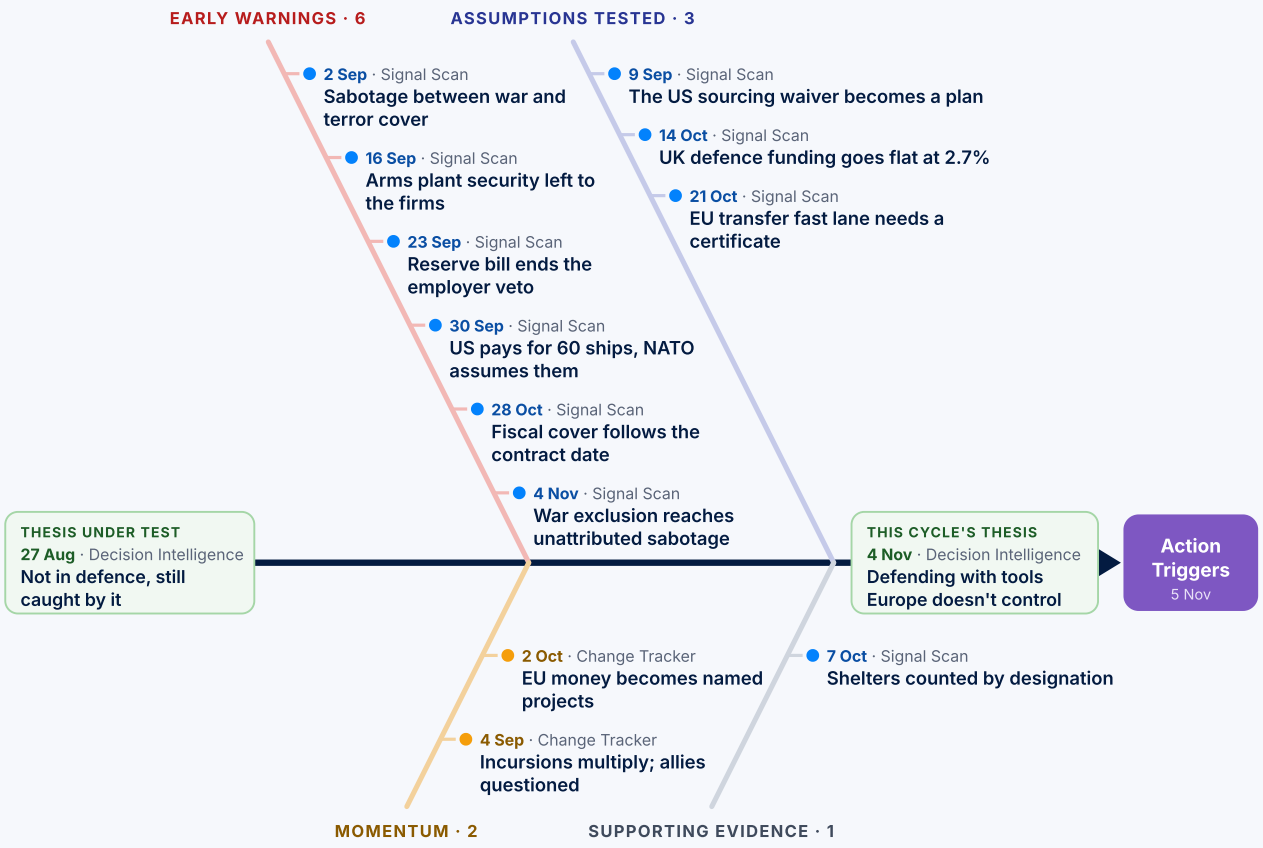
RAISE TO PREPARE If the Treasury confirms a spending review date later than 30 April 2027, extend bridging terms over the extra half-year and re-price UK capacity plans.

STAND DOWN If the spending review sets a funded date for 3% of GDP, plan capacity to it and close the watch.

IF YOU ACT ON ONE THING

Ask your brokers in writing whether a sabotage loss with a suspected but unproven state link would be paid, and price the answer before the January renewals.

DRAWING ON



Signal Scan Change Tracker Decision Intelligence

Each bone groups the deliverables by what they added, with the oldest at the outer end. Hover over any deliverable for its full title.

HOW THIS WAS MADE

The Decision-Grade Intelligence Method

Shaping Tomorrow's six-stage process for converting external change into decision-ready intelligence.

Scan · Filter · Stress-test · Judge · Trigger · Actionable Intelligence

See full methodology → · How we verify → · Track record →

This briefing is not another report. It is the synthesis produced after continuously monitoring signals, tracking change, testing assumptions and updating scenarios throughout the cycle on **Defence, Security & Resilience**. Its purpose is to identify the points at which accumulated evidence has become decision-changing: the early warnings the work caught before consensus formed, the assumptions that have shifted

between cycles, and the actions now decision-shaped enough to act on. Continuous intelligence on this topic is available as a Single-Topic or Multi-Topic programme.

Discuss a Tailored Programme

Prepared by Shaping Tomorrow: 5 November 2026